Daniela Banda-Hernandez

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EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA – Los Angeles, CA — Expected May 2028

Bachelor of Science in *Computer Science Games*

AWARDS: HSF Scholar, HITEC Scholar, QuestBridge Scholar

RELEVANT COURSES: Video Game Programming, Mobile Game Development, Game Design Workshop, Data Structures

TECHNICAL SKILLS

PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES: C++, C#, Java, JavaScript, Python

TOOLS: Unity, Perforce, Git/GitHub, Ink, Adobe Creative Suite, Figma

LANGUAGES (spoken): English, Spanish (bilingual)

GAME PROJECTS

Ur SO Messy! - CTIN 489: Intermediate Game Design Workshop — Sep 2026 - Present

Gameplay Programmer & Technical Designer

- Programmed the matching mini-game on a 2-person team, including card spawning, match checking, and a timer.
- Built a data-driven affection system with ScriptableObjects, where mini-game results shape each date.
- Wrote custom shaders that desaturate and hue-shift cards to scale difficulty, migrating to URP for Shader Graph.
- Implemented day progression and per-chat dialogue state with Ink, unlocking new suitors each day.

Wax Out! - MFA Thesis — Sep 2025 - May 2026

Gameplay Engineer & UI/UX Designer

- Engineered gameplay systems and reusable UI components in C# on a cross-functional team using Perforce.
- Partnered with designers to translate player-flow requirements into maintainable interface code.

Open Your Browser (OYB) - Open Alpha — Jan 2025 - May 2025

Game Design Lead

- Led a 10-person design team to ship a game on itch.io, directing characters, dialogue, and world-building.
- Partnered with programmers to implement narrative content and procedural systems in Unity.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Booz Allen Hamilton - El Segundo, CA — Jun 2026 - Aug 2026

Software Engineering Intern

- Built a real-time 3D globe in React Three Fiber showing satellite orbits, ground assets, and coverage areas.
- Created timeline playback, scheduling, and constellation-control tools for simulating satellite missions.
- Led frontend and UX across 80+ React components, designing the landing page, 3D intro, logo, and visual identity.
- Integrated REST APIs for mission-plan storage, location data, and live satellite orbit (TLE) updates.

Lvl∞nity - Los Angeles, CA — Jan 2026 - Present

Co-Founder, *Backend & Full-stack Developer*

- Co-founded a game-inspired social platform for collaborative project sharing, built with React and Firebase.
- Architected the database schema and REST APIs powering user profiles and project sharing.
- Implemented secure authentication flows and core backend business logic.
- Built end-to-end features connecting responsive React interfaces to backend services.

USC Games Career Center - Los Angeles, CA — Sep 2026 - Present

Student Assistant

- Coordinate career fairs, workshops, and recruiter events connecting USC Games students with studios and alumni.

LEADERSHIP

Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers (SHPE) — Aug 2024 - Present

Co-Vice President of Marketing

- Co-lead chapter marketing across social media and events, helping double mentorship sign-ups year over year.
- Design branded flyers, graphics, and digital content for chapter events and recruitment.